ENES 101 - Lecture 9-15

Lecture 9: ARGUEMENTS

- What is an argument?
- Evidence is critical, audience as a reader.
- Refuting the opposing argument = counter argument
- To get your reader or audience to agree with your position despite the opposing argument.

- Think about issues.
- Understand issues without emotion or bias.
- Discern contradictory claims.
- Form opinions about the kind of evidence and way things have been investigated.
- State your thoughts plainly, correctly, and reliably.
- Fact-checked.
- Think about and respectfully consider other people's ideas.

- Read an argument for studies.
- Highlight the main point.
- Interact with the text by writing notes on the side.
- Jot down the counterarguments on the side.

= Main Claim (pov)
= Supporting evidence
= Possible counter-arguments (refutation/concession)
= Evidence (facts, examples, statistics, definitions)
= Source

- **Main claim** -> open to debate
  - "Smoking is haram" - debatable.
  - Needs to be a controversial topic.
  - Claim shouldn't be self-claimable.
  - Not an opinion.
  - Supported by evidence.
  - Logic, emotion, ethics, analogy, experience -> **Soft Evidence.**
  - Statistics, authority, examples -> **Hard Evidence.**
  - Expert evidence.
  - Prewriting.
  - Sufficient amount of evidence.
  - Comprehensive, and relevant.
  - Verifiable - footnote.
  - Dependable.
  - Trustworthy, well-researched.

- Avoid generalization
- Not too much emotional language

- Keywords used in both introductions and conclusions

Lecture 10: PLAGIARISM/ PARAPHRASING

- Plagiarism - stealing someone else's work
- Intentionally or unintentionally
- Writing down word for word - quotation marks/citing the source
- Penalties - plagiarism - claiming that it is yours
- Stealing at an academic level
- Professor familiar with your writing style
- Always use your own words
- Not last minute - a little each day
- Before its due (days or week)
- Reading sources and copying sentences
- Shortening is better and putting it in your own words
- Brief notes
- Don't go back to the sources once you have made notes
- Consequences of plagiarism
- Parenthesis, footnotes
- Copying is not allowed
- No learning takes place when one copies
- Starts with note taking
- Copying parts = stands out

Examples of plagiarism

- No exact same order for writing
- Add quotation marks
- Use Brackets

Software used to detect plagiarism

- Plag tracker, Grammarly, TurnItIn

PARAPHRASING

- Restating something in a different manner without using altering the original meaning
- Take notes and don't use the same wording
- Less to no similar wording
- Don't use synonyms

Lecture 11: THE WRITING PROCESS

Steps of The Writing Process:

- Prewriting
- Writing
- Revising
- Editing

- Publishing

One : PREWRITING

- First and the most important step in the writing process.
- Brainstorming, Planning = is prewriting OR is an example of prewriting.
- Jotting down ideas in a list and revise prewriting.
- Combine all ideas together
- Go back and order them
- Different formats : lists, bullets, outline or a mind map.
- Anything that helps you generate ideas.

Second : WRITING

- Staged drafting (writing the rough draft).
- Not meant to be perfect.
- Tips:
- 1. You are in an environment that is free of distractions.
- 2. Know your audience.
- 3. Do not look at the sources (tempted to plagiarize).
- 4. Keep your prewriting in front of you and turn them into complete sentences.

Third : REVISING

- Focus on content.
  - Organization, flow and effective thesis statement, check if something is missing.
  - Read it aloud.
  - Not worried about grammar at this stage.
  - Paragraphs in correct order.
  - ***Questions to ask yourself while Organizing:***
  - *1. Is there s clear introduction, body, and conclusion?*
  - *2. Does the introduction provide sufficient background for the reader addressed?*
  - *3. Is there a thesis sentence? Is the purpose of the essay clear?*
  - *4. Does the essay move from general to specific?*
  - *5. Are there sufficient transitions between related ideas?*
  - *6. Is the overall organization murky or clean? In other words, does switching subjects in the middle of a paragraph in the body?*
  - *Does every paragraph address the subject matter of the thesis in some way?*
  - ***Content and Style***
  - *Does the easy show that the writer has a knowledge of the audience?*
  - *Is the length appropriate and adequate?*
  - *Has the writer used sufficient examples and detail to make his or her points clear?*
  - *Has the assignment been addressed?*
  - *Is the tone of the essay professional and appropriate?*
  - *Is the language convincing, clear and concise?*
  - *Has the writer used fresh language and a creative approach?*

- ***Research and Sources***
- *Are al sources credible?*
- *Is the research accurate, unbiased and complete?*
- *Has the writer fully interpreted the findings?*
- *Has the writer commented on each source used?*
- *Is the analysis based on hard evidence?*
- *Is the analysis free of faulty reasoning?*

Fourth : EDITING

- Focusing on mechanical errors.
  - Grammar, punctuation etc.
  - Avoid repetitions or the same type of structure in the entire paper.
  - Verbs
  - MUGS: mechanics, usage, grammar, spelling

Fifth : PUBLISHING

- Turning in your final draft.
- Read the whole thing before turning it in.
- Conferencing during different stages.
- Get someones's Feedback.
- Writing questions throughout the paper to help in revision.
- Correcting errors if any.

Lecture 12: PREWRITING

- *Why Prewriting is Important?* It is like a Pillar is to a building, no foundation and may collapse.
- It could be list, mind map, outline, or in a question format.
- Writing has stages, like reading.
- Intro - some people like to write w/o going thru process.
- Note taking for research papers- don't write word to word.

Activity

- Does not require any order.
- Topic in the middle.
- Ask questions and brainstorm.
- Add numbers next to it to order it after the brainstorming.
- Format for Outlining.
- Cannot have a roman 1 without a 2 and a capital A without a B.

Lecture 13: PREWRITING PT. 2

- Make a list of ideas.
  - Google topic to generate more ideas.
  - List sources. Choose from professional sources.
  - Write Thesis statement
  - Take notes from the sources. (Second prewriting in note format)
  - Make an outline from notes (list of ideas, notes from different sources, outline)

Lecture 14: TOPIC SENTENCE/THESIS STATEMENT

- Rough draft (2nd step)
- Functional paragraph
- Write with the first thing that comes into your mind, keep that flow going.
- Paragraph = a unit that consists of several sentences, five or ten, around a particular idea or topic. Consists of 50-200 words.
- In academic writing, topic sentence sums up the main idea of the paragraph, most often the first sentence, but can be anywhere.
- Supporting details (facts, quotes etc)
- Conclusion sentence that is related to the topic sentence. It is a sentence which summarizes the main idea of the paragraph.

Topic Sentence

- Indicates to the main points of the paragraph, it might state what is anticipated in the paragraph.
- It could be a statement supported by an evidence.
- Might be a strong statement with a conviction, and then supporting sentences go on to explain it.
- Topic sentence shouldn't be an obvious fact.
- Neither a vague opinion.
- A topic sentence is the one that you can write multiple sentences to.
- The line that gives several different things.

Thesis Statement

> Introduces the main idea of the essay.

- It states the specific topic of the essay.
- It may list the subtopics of the main topic.
- It may also mention the method of the organization.
- It is the last sentence of the introduction.

Different Types of Thesis Statements

> *Analytical paper* = breaks down an issue or an idea into its component parts, evaluates the issue or idea, and presents this breakdown and evaluation to the audience.

> *Expository (explanatory) paper* = explains something to the audience.

> *Argumentative paper* = makes a claim about a topic and justifies this claim with specific evidence. (Claim = opinion, a policy proposal, an evaluation, a cause and effect statement or an interpretation)

Goal = persuade the audience that claim is true.

Topic + Opinion = Thesis statement

Is Your Thesis Strong?

- Do I answer the question?
  - Have I taken a position that others might challenge or oppose?
  - Is my thesis statement specific enough?
  - Does my thesis pass the "so what?" Test?
  - Does my essay support my thesis specifically and without wandering?

- Does my thesis pass the “how and why”?

Lecture 15: REVISING

> What is revising? = adding or deleting words or sentences, changing the order of the paragraphs, focusing only on content and not mechanics
> Revisiting something, to look at something from a fresh, critical perspective.
> Organize them in a logical order.
> Check the wording and check if you have written the right words.
> Have someone to read them. Help write down questions to guide you.

Steps to consider

- Examine the balance within your paper
  - Check that you have kept your promise to the reader
  - Check the organization
  - Check your information
  - Check your conclusion

Effective Revision Tips

- Perfecting the work you’ve done, not rewriting the entire paper.
- Adding to your paper, improving the paper.
- Track changes.
- Revise it out loud, it’s easier to know the flow of the paper and recognize mistakes.
- Start out with a working thesis.
- Practice makes perfect.
- Avoid using the same word again and again.
- Check if there are any unanswered question.

Revision Checklist - Thesis Driven Papers

> Does the paper fulfill the assignment and instructor expectations?

- Is the overall structure of your paper clear and logical?
- Hook (introduction), grabbing the reader’s attention.
- Discussion of Topic - discusses the topic.
- Introduction of text(s) and author(s)
- Thesis (introduction) - States a claim which relates to Humanity and is targeted to the given task question.
- Claim
- Background information
- Evidence (structure and mechanics)
- Citations (structure and mechanics)
- Evidence relevancy
- Explanation (sophisticated explanation connected to the claim)
- Analysis (sophisticated connection to the thesis)
- Concluding sentence for the body paragraph
- Conclusion (restates the thesis in a new and insightful way)

> Is the overall structure of your paper clear and logical?
> Do you support your ideas or arguments with sufficient evidence?
> Is each paragraph well structured?